Kairos

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/47713366.

Rating:
Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warning:
Major Character Death

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F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

Character:
Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), Hordak (She-Ra), Mara (She-Ra), Light Hope (She-Ra)

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Kairos

by Bluliu

Summary

The first time it was an accident. The second time, Catra made a stupid mistake. All of the times she's done this, there’s been an unidentifiable factor of despair waiting for her. There was always some doomed fate for the two of them. Catra anticipated it that way. So of course she didnt anticipate an elevator being the solution?

Or,

In a world where aging freezes at 22 until the meeting of a soulmate, Catra has been alive for longer than she cares to count.

Or,

Catra and Adora arecomplicated, Adora reincarnates and hate's her birthday.

Notes

This is pretty short but I'm a little proud of myself!

See the end of the work for more notes

Catra is 22. She's been 22 for a very long time. And even though that particular phrasing of her age makes her feel like that white paper bag of sticks from Twilight, it is what it is.

Etheria is a damnable place to live;its inhabitants are perpetually cursed to its surface, frozen when they turn 22 until they meet the other half of their soul. No one knows what universal system decides who gets who, and yeah, there are theories, but that mystery will never be solved. And as for what Catra thinks?

She's never believed in god, but she's seen the hand of the devil one too many times.

⊹⊹⊹

They met when they were 19Bug-eyed young women saddled with the weight of their families, it was so obvious they'd be friends. It could almost be seen as a little bit like fate.
It was 1845, and Catra's father, Hordak, had dragged her family west. For gold or work, she didn't know, but she did know that everyone in her family but her and her father had died.
Adora was a part of another family traveling with them, left in a similar situation where it was just her and her older sister Mara after sickness, bandits, and a thousand other lovely things took her family. Hordak couldn't be bothered to put more effort into being her father past the basic upkeep needed to keep her alive, and Catra naturally drifted closer to the pair of sisters.

You see, Catra knew many things about Adora. Adora had hair the color of prairie grass after dawn. Her eyes were pools of watercolor blue that drowned Catra every time she looked into them. It made her never want to breathe again.

You see, Catra knew too many things about Adora.

Catra was 20 when she learned what a soulmate was. It was morning when it happened. The last grasping light of the moon was fading, framing Adora's sleeping face as Catra sat next to her .

Mara had been drunk, regaling Catra with the stories of a Woman named Hope. Her 'soulmate' is what Mara had called her.

"There's a common misconception of soulmates, Catra." Mara wasn't looking at her; there was a distance in her eyes. At that moment, Mara was far, far away from herself. "All people want to think that a soulmate is what will be what completes them, and the craziest thing is that at the bare bones of it, a soulmate is a mirror."

The bottle of whiskey had slipped from Mara's grasp, "Catra, you're going to meet the most important person in your life in two years. They'll call attention to you, show you life, and more. Make you more *you*."

Mara turned her head to meet Catra's eyes. "They'll be carried with you forever."

Catra looked at Adora's moon-washed face with that statement burned into her soul.

⊹⊹⊹

Catra's twenty-second birthday was the worst day of her life. Cruelly enough, she and Adora had the same birthday, another knob of fate locked in the intricacy of their relationship.

Not that they had a relationship, to begin with, at the time.

The moon was nearing the highest point of its zenith when it happened. There had been a fight with her father. A years-long

dispute over her friendship with Adora. In the beginning, Hordak had been aggressively pointing out the "intensity" of the two of them. That devolved into accusations of what he believed to be "sinful."

He had charged, and she had grabbed a rock.

She didn't see Adora running between them to stop Hordak from hurting her. She didn't see the rock connecting with Adora's head. All she saw was red.

And well,

Catra's witnessed death before.

The haunting drain of life from the skin and eyes wasn't new. In Catra's addled mind, she had a passing thought; how unfair it was that Adora's eyes were still so beautiful even in death.

She had looked down at the shattered mirror of her soul and understood that her reflection wouldn't be changing for a very long time.

⊹⊹⊹

The second time is when Catra realizes she is very unlucky.

Twenty-two years. Twenty-two years had passed, and what was Catra doing with her time? Drowning in alcohol.

She was sitting in a dingy nowhere bar in 1867 when she was joined by a stranger.

It's undoubtedly Adora. And this should undoubtedly be a miracle; her soulmate had returned somehow.

There's no rhyme or reason to the following events, the things that happened nek
Another implausible accident she doesn't care to elaborate on, more red shades of red to flood Catra's vision.

Something happens when Catra meets the painted sea of her soulmate's eyes as she holds Adora's limp body.

The part of her heart that belongs to Adora is cracked.

Catra leaves that bar covered in blood.

⊹⊹⊹

Catra hates having a soulmate. She despises it.

It's a fact. Grass is green, you can't trust politicians, and Catra has a soulmate and hates it.
It was easier than breathing. Easier than loving. Easier than living.

To be the one to end the other half of her soul, a name stained on her heart, connecting them-a universal constant pulling them into each other for eternity.

Catra hates having a soulmate.

Catra's soulmate is Adora.

She still knows many things about Adora.

She knows the wrinkles at the corners of her eyes that pull together when she graces someone with a smile. She knows Adora's weathered hands, the symphonies of tales the scars and calluses

tell. Her eyes. Blue. Not like the sky. Not like the sea. A well of color with the vastness of space that pulls her in, heavier than the weight of the sky. Indescribable.

She still knows too many things about Adora.

God, She loves Adora. Catra was forever stuck in a well of emotional ambivalence. She wants Adora like she's a starving beast throwing itself at the bars of a cage. She's battered by dreams of Adora, memories of death. The two are a dizzying affair, the intersection of fate met with blood splatter on the ground.

176.
176 years of brutalizing the love of her life, every single time a new experience.

When Adora turns 22 is when it happens. Catra never really has to look for her;the cogs of the universe ensure that they meet. And the cogs of the universe ensure that Catra can never have her.

Over time she's gotten used to it and even had some insane situations. The craziest was in 1979 with a chia pet. She couldn't keep the damn thing alive, so of course, it had been this round of Adora's reincarnation long-coming doom. The universe loved to laugh at her.

And to be clear, Catra hasn't been using her extended life very well; she's barely even traveled.
Probably because she's wanted for murder in most countries on Etheria.

The first time it was an accident. The second time, Catra made a stupid mistake. All the times she's done this, there's been an unidentifiable factor of despair waiting for her. There was always some doomed fate for the two of them. Catra anticipated it that way. So why didn't she expect to get stuck in an elevator?

Catra just wanted to get to her apartment when surprise, surprise Adora entered. Which wasn't supposed to happen, Adora turned 22 the next month, and this was the first time Catra had run into her before that date.

And then the elevator had decided to give into the failings of humanity, and there they were 20 minutes of silence later with Catra staring at a wall.

That silence didn't last for long.

Adora's eyes locked onto Catra's face, her voice filled with a depth of emotion Catra couldn't identify. "I... I remember everything each time. Did you know that?" she questioned, her voice laden with an unspoken weight.

The snap of her head was so fast it could've broken Catra's neck; she had never learned that particular facet of their fucked up dance routine.

"Oh."

"Is that all you have to fucking say , Catra?"

Catra's face screwed up into an expression of vague confusion, "What the hell do you want from me, Adora?"

The silence that had plagued them earlier seemed to return with that question.

Until Adora broke her soul for a second time.

"I've been me this whole time, Catra; I remember everything, every death, every life, every opportunity robbed of me."

Adora slid into place next to Catra's position on the elevator floor, "Why, Catra?" Adora questioned, her voice shaking with a mix of anguish and that everpresent pool of lingering love. "Why do we keep doing this? It only ever ends badly."

The only answer Catra could give was to lean in and kiss her. And-

An orchestra of silence pulses in her head. Lips meet. Catra wants to pull her closer, drink her in, live in her soul.
It's just the two of them, hearts in the desert reunited with nothing but a sweet melody humming in Catra's head.

The time it took for them to pull away was somehow between infinity and eons. All that was left was the two staring at each other's eyes.

Oh.

Oh.

This was the last time.

And like all the times Catra has left her limp and lifeless, Adora left Catra sitting in that elevator alone.

End Notes

I don't really Write a lot so if if anyone somehow sees this, I hope you enjoy it :)))

Edit: If people would like it I could make a continuous story!

Please drop by the archive and comment to let the author know if you enjoyed their work!